it at length, as opposed to merely referencing it, in the hope of greater dissemination of important decolonial scholarship, such as that of De Roover.

Coming to his book, De Roover sheds light on the Protestant politico-theological framework behind the distinction that the ‘modern’ nation-states (including those formerly colonised) make between the spiritual and the temporal or secular. According to him, this distinction significantly informed the Protestant Reformation which started in the sixteenth century. His view is that the liberal model of religious toleration and secularism, which continues to have purchase in the West and in decolonised States, is based on the specific theological framework that was conceptually conceived of during the Protestant Reformation. He calls it the ‘crystallization of the political theology of Christian freedom and the two Kingdoms’. His insights on this subject and the nexus that he unearths between the political theology arising from the Protestant Reformation and the very definition of what it means to be a Christian are profound and extremely relevant for decolonised societies that have inherited the European political structure. His work is an essential reading in my opinion, especially for indigenous societies, for them to become aware of the patently non-secular context of the modern distinction between the ‘spiritual’ and the ‘secular’ because it calls out the claim of neutral application of values, such as secularism, which have been inherited from the coloniser.

According to De Roover, to appreciate the true nature of ‘secularisation’ of Christianity achieved by and through the Protestant Reformation, one must understand what the specific object of ‘reformation’ was. This requires us to delve briefly into Roman Catholic OET prior to the Protestant Reformation, and more specifically into the process of ‘Conversion’. Today, while conversion in the context of Christianity is synonymous with proselytisation of non-Christians in order to bring them into the Christian fold, the very first people who underwent ‘conversion’ were the Christians themselves. The process of Conversion, however, refers to a structured spiritual regimen that was evolved in the medieval age by Christian monks in monasteries (who were distinct from the clergy) to achieve a true Christian life of absolute submission to God. Submission to the Creator meant obedience and sacrificing individual purpose at the altar of the divine purpose. The specific goal of the process was to ‘re-form’ man in the image